Aishwarya Arya, PMP

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Professional Summary

Results-driven Project Manager with over 7 years of experience in biotechnology research and development, complemented by an MBA and PMP certification. Proven expertise in leading cross-functional teams, managing complex projects from conception to completion, and optimizing laboratory operations. Adept at aligning project objectives with organizational goals, ensuring timely delivery within scope and budget. Skilled in stakeholder communication, risk management, and process improvement, with a strong foundation in scientific research methodologies

Experience

RD Manager, Genetics, Stanford University – Palo Alto, CA August 2023 – Present

- Designed and executed complex molecular and cell biology experiments, including CRISPR-based gene editing, protein and nucleic acid purification, and live cell imaging
- Spearheaded project timelines and resource allocation, balancing research priorities and operational needs to meet scientific and business objectives
- Contributed to manuscript preparation and co-authored scientific papers, assisting with the reporting of findings and technological advances. (one submitted, one in progress)
- Developed and managed lab operations and infrastructure, optimizing workflows, and maintaining a streamlined supply chain for research materials and equipment
- Served as the laboratory safety officer, ensuring compliance with Environment, Health and Safety guidelines and updating SOPs

Research Associate III and Scrum Master, Greenlight Biosciences – Lexington, MA February 2021 – July 2023

- Led and produced the company's proprietary ITS sequence resulting in higher titers of mRNA and potency
- Synthesized mRNAs using cell free reactions (CFR) at microliter scale for QC of raw materials and optimized the CFR for mRNA production
- Designed and produced more than 300 different templates and corresponding mRNAs for potential mRNA-based therapeutics and a human-health platform wide use within the company for various disease payloads
- Developed expertise in troubleshooting batch variations within production of various vectors expressing different reporter systems using different methods.
- Optimized cloning and mRNA production workflows to maximize mRNA throughput
- Improved synthesis across various target candidates (covid, influenza, viral proteins) by optimizing IVT reaction conditions, increasing the mRNA purity to 93
- Presented data in various small and large group settings; suggested innovative ideas/concepts of moderate to complex variables and collaborated successfully with multiple teams including gene therapy, preclinical production, analytical and RNA technology team
- Created a common repository for shared plasmids: creating a plasmid inventory with key information (ID, plasmid production ID, NTP stoichiometry, product length)

Research Associate I, Department of Entomology, Agriculture and Lifesciences, Texas A and M University – College Station, TX April 2020 – January 2021

- Extracting DNA, performing PCRs, run agarose gels, purify amplicons and analyze sequencing results for a given gene
- Using CRISPR/Cas9-guide RNA system, HDR and NHEJ DNA repair pathways to study various knock-out models
- Culturing and isolating plasmids using mini, midi and maxi prep (Zymo, Qiagen Kit)
- Carrying out restriction digestion, ligation and transformation of cells, sequence clones
- Analyzing, recording data and presenting results weekly during lab meetings

Research Associate I, College of Veterinary Medicine, Texas A and M University – College Station, TX October 2018 – April 2020

- Performed advanced processing, embedding, cutting of paraffin embedded and cryo-sectioned animal tissues
- Performed immunohistochemistry and specialized staining procedures on paraffin embedded tissue cut slides
- Analyzed tissue slides under brightfield and fluorescence modes using 3DHISTECH panoramic digital slide scanner to study disease progression
- Trained lab personnel involving students, research assistants to use various techniques and instruments

Education

Executive MBA- New England College July 2021-July 2023

Henniker, New Hampshire

MS Biotechnology- Texas A and M University August 2016-May 2018

College Station, TX

Technologies

Software and Management Skills: JMP, Microsoft Teams, SharePoint, FlowJo Graph-pad Prism, DNASTAR Lasergene, SnapGene, Image-J Imaging, Python, R, SQL, MATLAB, Geneious, Electronic Lab Archives, Benchling, Trello (Agile Project Management), EPIC, Microsoft Word, Project, Excel, PowerPoint, Salesforce Analytics, Agile/Scrum methodologies, SQL, Java (Basic), Advanced Excel (Simulation), Decision technologies, Statistical Analysis, R modeling, Tableau, Project Analytics, Risk Analysis, Business Process Redesign, Market Segmentation, Market Positioning and Messaging, Win/Loss Analysis, B2B Marketing.